

THE ART OF NEGOTIATION: SHIFT THE CONVERSATION, WIN THE DEAL



THE ART OF NEGOTIATION

Written by Julien D'Auria

Negotiation is more than a battle of tactics – it's a strategic conversation that can shape deals and relationships. This insights paper explores how to shift the focus from winning individual points to achieving shared success, creating better outcomes for all parties involved.

This week, I was working with a private equity team, who were deep into negotiating term sheets for a potential acquisition. A critical insight surfaced as we unpacked their strategy: too often, negotiations get stuck in the weeds of tactics, and the broader goals and relationships are sidelined.

One of the most potent shifts we explored was reframing the conversation. Instead of focusing solely on "winning" each point, we looked at how to align on shared interests and address the counterparty's underlying concerns. It's amazing how much leverage you can gain simply by asking the right questions and showing you're invested in a win-win outcome.



THE ART OF NEGOTIATION

Here are a few negotiation strategies we discussed that can help shift the dynamic in your next deal:

- Prepare for “no” and use it strategically. A well-timed pause or pushback can demonstrate strength and clarity. Be ready to counter with solutions that protect your interests while keeping the conversation moving forward.
- Find their pressure points. Negotiations are rarely just about price. Timing, terms, or even personal priorities often hold the key to unlocking agreement. Dig deep and stay curious about what truly matters to the other side.



- Start with the end in mind. Before walking into the room, be crystal clear on your must-haves, deal-breakers, and areas for flexibility. Then, frame your offers and counteroffers to guide the conversation toward that ideal outcome.
- Stay steady under pressure. Negotiations often involve tension and uncertainty. The key is to hold your ground without escalating. Build rapport, project confidence, and don't let the heat of the moment pull you off track.

Negotiation is as much about mindset as it is about skill. The most effective negotiators focus on solutions, not standoffs. They watch the bigger picture while navigating the details with precision and empathy – from high-stakes deals, managing internal buy-in, or strengthening client relationships, we're here to help. At Hatwell, we equip you with the skills and confidence to achieve better outcomes. Get in touch today.

USA & LATAM

Hatwell Group

230 Park Avenue

3rd Floor

New York

NY 10169

Tel : +1 (332) 900 5060

UK, Europe & Asia

Hatwell Group

Connect House

133-37 Alexandra House

Wimbledon, United Kingdom

SW19 7JU

Tel : +44 7944858211